



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

What seems to be the problem?



Learning Outcome

Describe routines and regular activities in a wider range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever asked for technical support over the phone?
- Are you polite when responding to a suggestion? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about a technical problem and solution.
- I can respond politely to suggestions.
- I can say what people are doing now or in the future.





Let's Explore!

What's wrong with Peter's laptop?



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Saul:** Hello, Fordy's Computers, IT Department. This is Saul speaking. How can I help you?
- Peter:** Hello Saul. I just bought this laptop! I really hope you guys will take it back. I can't figure out all the gadgets on this thing!
- Saul:** Well, before we consider that, what seems to be the current issue? We should be able to fix it.
- Peter:** Amazing, I'd be grateful! It seems to freeze up all the time. I am turning it on right now. Still frozen!
- Saul:** I'll try to troubleshoot with you. Try pressing the "esc" key.
- Peter:** I really appreciate your assistance, but this is not working. I also clear my cache all the time. It's useless!
- Saul:** Here's what I would do. Try shutting everything down. Then restart and try running your computer for a while without the external hard drive.
- Peter:** I will need this thing working soon. I'm going to a meeting tomorrow. The keyboard seems to turn off at times.
- Saul:** Why don't you reset it to the original settings?
- Peter:** Sounds great! Let me see what that does. It works! Thank you so much!





Let's Practice!

Technically*, are those technical words?

*"technically" is an adverb used to mean things like officially, actually and really.

Instructions: Read the following text about Jesse and Samantha chatting about their plans. Underline all the technical computer words or phrases in the paragraph.

I can't figure out the problem with my laptop. I turn it on and it immediately freezes up. There are too many gadgets on this thing! I called the computer store and they helped me troubleshoot it. I have to restart it without the external hard drive. Let's hope it works, otherwise let's hope they'll take it back!



Let's Practice!

Samantha uses reduced form in her speech. What forms is she using?

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Correct 1 mistake per sentence. Read the correct sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. I'm turnning it on now.
2. I'm going to a meting tomorrow.
3. I am clering the cache to see if it helps.
4. He is resting the computer right now.
5. I really hope you guys will teik it back.
6. I will ned this thing working soon.





Extension Activity

Discover technical issues and try to fix them.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Describe a simple technical computer problem to your partner.
- Think about and explore possible causes.
- Discuss possible solutions.
- Switch roles.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I can describe a simple technical computer problem with my partner.

☐ ☐

I can think about and explore possible causes.

☐ ☐

I can discuss possible solutions.

☐ ☐

I can switch roles.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- gadget** (noun): a small, ingenious device
e.g. Peter has a lot of gadgets.
- to figure out** (verb): to understand; to find a solution
e.g. I can't figure out all the gadgets in this thing!
- cache** (noun): a part of a computer's memory where information is kept
e.g. I clear my cache all the time.
- laptop** (noun): a small computer that is designed to be easily carried
e.g. I bought this laptop yesterday and it's not working.
- hard drive** (noun): a device that is used for storing computer data
e.g. Try running your computer without the external hard drive.
- to take back** (verb): to return something to the place you bought it
e.g. I hope you will take back the laptop.
- to freeze up** (verb): to stop working (for an electronic device)
e.g. I try to work on my computer, but it freezes up all the time.





Learning Points

Describing and Solving a Technical Problem

We often have issues with our computers, phones and other electronic devices. Sometimes we have to call a repair company to help us get through the problems and find a solution.

Here are some typical phone problems and troubleshooting (solving) examples:

Describing a Problem	Solving a Problem
It seems to ...	Try resetting the ...
It doesn't seem to ...	Did you try ... ?
The screen always ...	Try pressing the ...
Whenever I use the ...	I suggest you just ...

Examples:

• **Peter:** *It seems to freeze up all the time.*

Technician: *Try pressing the "esc" key.*

Responding Politely to Suggestions

When people offer you suggestions, you should always respond in a *polite way*. You do not want to offend the person offering their suggestion.

Suggestion	Polite response
You should try to ...	Thank you, I'll try that.
You might want to ...	Great idea, that's helpful, thanks.
Maybe you need a ...	Sounds excellent!
It may just need a ...	That sounds easy, thanks!

Examples:

• **Technician:** *You should try shutting down your computer.*

Peter: *Sounds excellent!*

